

LEGEZA CLASSIC

Boys all-stars to play April 1

VERMILION — A total of 40 boys players will gather for the Lorain County Boys Basketball Coaches Association's (LCBBCA) annual Gene Legeza Classic, the all-star games for the county's senior players, at Vermilion High School on April 1.

The Classic is named in honor of the longtime Chronicle-Telegram sports writer, who unexpectedly died in December of 1992 at the age of 52.

John Szalay of Clearview and Mark Feldmann of First Baptist will coach the North team against the South team coached by Michael Scott of Firelands in the evening's first game at 6 p.m.

At approximately 7:45, the East team coached by Troy DiFranco of Midview and Kurt Habermehl of Vermilion will face the West team coached by

Bob Walsh of Elyria and Tom Eibel of Wellington.

A highlight of the evening's festivities will be the naming of the 2007 Mr. Basketball for Lorain County, in addition to the recognition of the Association's all-Lorain County teams.

NORTH TEAM
Amherst: Gianni Catalano; Clearview: Miles Nevin; Mike Rosey; Columbia: Lee Palmer; Elyria Catholic: Kyle Arroyo; Corbin Schleifer; First Baptist: Sam Goodrich; Lake Ridge: Taylor Rangel; Midview: Chase Williams; Southview: Jonathan Quinones; COACHES: John Szalay (Clearview); Mark Feldmann (First Baptist).

SOUTH TEAM
Admiral King: J.T. Feldkamp; Avon: Ray Lopez; Avon Lake: Jordan Frank; Brookside: Manny King; Firelands: Zach Engel; Keystone: Aaron Lindstrom; North Ridgeville: Josh Kehl; Oberlin: Josh Daniels; Vermilion: J.P. Kelli; Cory Timbs; COACHES: Michael Scott (Admiral King); Steve Lias (Firelands).

EAST TEAM
Admiral King: Dominic Price; Amherst: Casey Copp; Clearview: Matt Chonko; Dash Sokol; Firelands: Bryan Hanna; Andrew Wiegand; Midview: Andy Gering; Joe Harder; Oberlin: Brandon Bowen; Vermilion: Colin Vorels; COACHES: Troy DiFranco (Midview); Kurt Habermehl (Vermilion).

WEST TEAM
Avon Lake: Dave Reichlin; Clearview: Troy Simmons; Elyria: Danny Noble; Jordan Thomas; Elyria Catholic: Andrew Kirsch; Brandon Williams; North Ridgeville: Dan Hunt; Open Door: Danny McClintic; Wellington: Jon Clark; Kory Conley; COACHES: Bob Walsh (Elyria); Tom Eibel (Wellington).

Girls all-star game slated for March 19

LaGRANGE — A total of 42 girls basketball players will gather for the Lorain County Girls Basketball Coaches Association's (LCGBCA) annual senior all-star games at Keystone High School on March 19.

Al Mielcarek of Avon and Larry Babics of Columbia will coach the Black team against the Gold team coached by Brian Ruggles of Oberlin and Scott Pizak of Southview in the evening's first game at 6 p.m.

At approximately 8 o'clock, the Blue team coached by Kim Kauffman of Midview and Anjie Caffarel of Vermilion will face the Red team coached by Cheryl Bansek of Admiral King and Dave Kudela of Firelands.

A highlight of the evening's festivities will be the naming of

the 2007 Miss Basketball for Lorain County, in addition to the recognition of the Association's all-Lorain County teams.

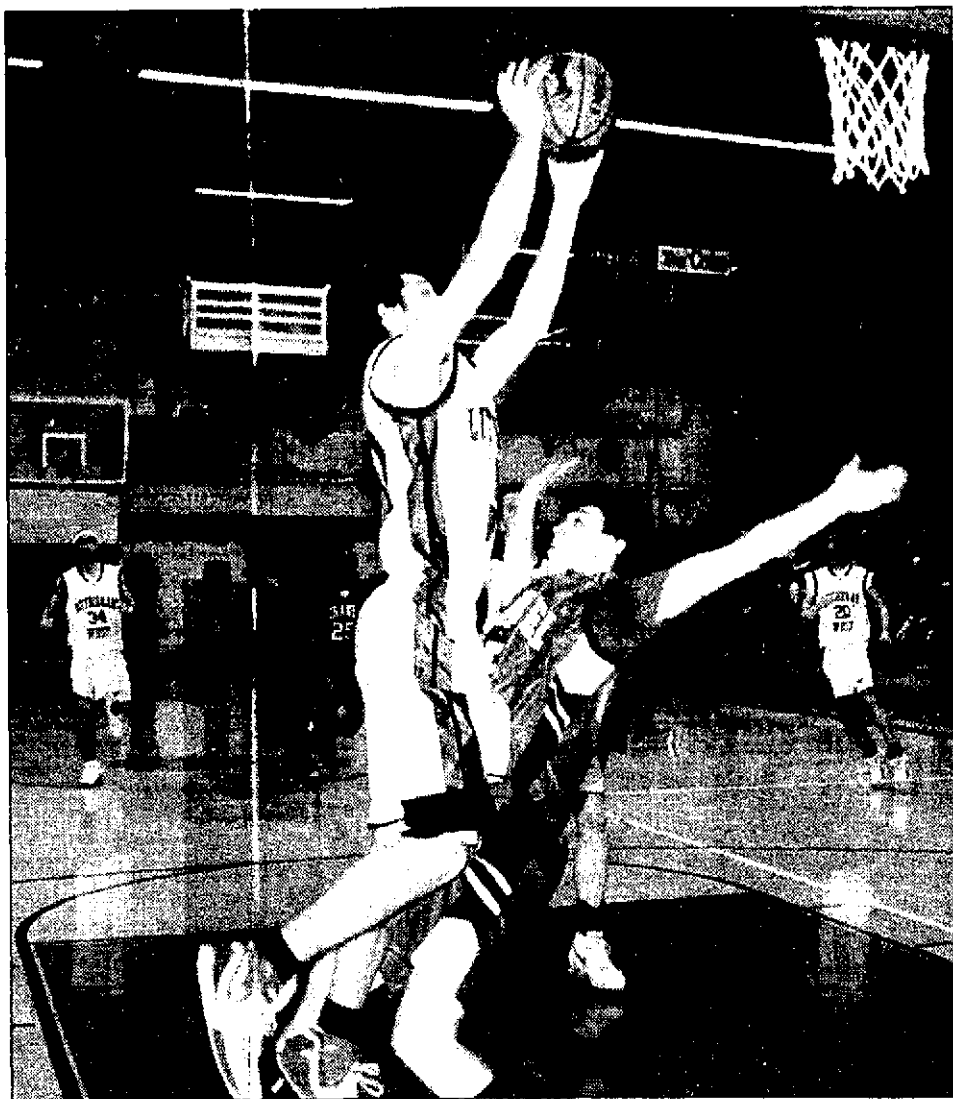
BLACK TEAM
Admiral King: Brittany Smith; Amherst: Allison Theobald; Avon: Chelsea Malloy; Brookside: Terry Urig; Clearview: Courtney Noster; Abbey Thompson; Columbia: Katie Dula; Katie Mahoney; Elyria Catholic: Casey Thompson; Lake Ridge: Katie Gardner; Mary Elise Toppi; COACHES: Al Mielcarek (Avon); Larry Babics (Columbia).

GOLD TEAM
Avon Lake: Alexis Brant; Brookside: Tiffany Morlock; Firelands: Kelley Volk; Keystone: Darlene Peim; Sarah Stromack; North Ridgeville: Adriana Bier; Oberlin: Brittany Daugherty; Southview: Latesha Evans; Kiang Hamilton; Vermilion: Mary Scott Clark; COACHES: Brian Ruggles (Oberlin); Scott Pizak (Southview).

BLUE TEAM
Amherst: Callie Bratcher; Middlefield: Sofia; Avon: Erica Repas; Black River: Megan Delbrick; Midview: Adrienne Eichlenau; Suzy Street; Vermilion: Allie LaForce; Jessica Neiding; Saddle Zander; Wellington: Brandi Hinkle; COACHES: Kim Kauffman (Midview); Anjie Caffarel (Vermilion).

RED TEAM
Admiral King: Larasha Kimbro; Dominique Star; Avon Lake: Kelsey Black; Katie Kilbane; Katie Pletch; Clearview: Naji Williams; Elyria: Jovanna Jackson; Firelands: Ali Stack; First Baptist: Stephanie Brown; Oberlin: Ashley Cunningham; Southview: Octavia Snipes; COACHES: Cheryl Bansek (Admiral King); Dave Kudela (Firelands).

DISTRICT BASKETBALL: DIVISION III



Lutheran West's Scott Voiers drives to the basket against Brendan Coyne of Chanel in Friday night's Division III District championship game.

'Horns rule Chanel

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — The last time Lutheran West's boys won a district basketball title they ended up in the Division III Final Four.

They won another Friday night and senior post Andrew Hofener said the Longhorns have the talent to make it back to Columbus.

If they do, it will be in part because of Hofener's big second half. The 6-foot-6 Hofener scored 16 points in the third and fourth quarters, sparking the Longhorns to a come-from-behind 71-64 victory over St. Peter Chanel. They led for the first time, 57-56, on Hofener's close-range basket with less than three minutes to play.

It delivers the Longhorns their first district crown since 1998. Lutheran West went on to win the Toledo regional, but was bounced in a state semifinal by Sparta Highland.

"We're definitely capable of going to the Final Four," Hofener said after helping cut down the nets in the Elyria High gym. "We just have to keep playing together as a team, go to our strength — defense — be strong inside, make our outside shots and I think we have a great chance to go to state."

First, however, the Longhorns have to win two regional games in the Canton Fieldhouse. Their Friday night win earned them an 8 p.m. Wednesday appointment with either Campbell Memorial or Youngstown Ursuline. They tangled for the Salem district crown Friday night.

The final score doesn't begin to tell the story of this

struggle, which left players, coaches and Lutheran West fans exhausted. Chanel (16-7) scored off the opening tip and led for the next 29 minutes. Lutheran West trailed 18-7 after the first quarter, 31-18 halfway through the second and 35-26 at the half.

"Our offense really stunk in the first half," said Longhorns coach Phil Argento. "I thought that was the result of the kind of pressure they were putting on us and us hurrying vs. adjusting to the speed of the game. That's probably the quickest team we've played all year."

The offense improved dramatically after the break. The Longhorns scored 45 points in the second half, 28 in the fourth quarter. And they were cool under pressure. Jacob O'Hara made 7-of-8 foul shots in the fourth quarter and the team made 10 straight in the final 90 seconds.

"We work on foul shots every day in practice and they just went in for me tonight," O'Hara said. "We knew we could come back. We played extremely well down the stretch and everybody played well."

"We didn't slow down (in the second half), we actually sped up," Argento said of the offense. "We wanted to run at them as much as they were coming at us. You always hear coaches talk about the importance of the first few minutes of the second half. Well, we came out and laid claim to the fact that we're not playing the same way."

Indeed, Lutheran West opened the third quarter with a 9-2 run that cut the deficit to

38-35. The Firebirds pulled ahead by five and six points before the period ended, but in the final minute Hofener then scored twice in the paint to cut Chanel's lead to 45-43 going into the fourth.

The Longhorns tied it at 45 on Scott Voiers' basket early in the quarter and it was tied at 47 and 49 before Chanel pulled ahead 56-51. Then midway through the quarter, Lutheran West got a huge boost when Andrew Thomas drilled a long 3-point basket to cut the Chanel lead to 56-54.

"I knew that shot came off my fingers pretty good," Thomas said. "I just launched the three and it went in."

It was the Longhorns' 65th victory in their last 66 games, and fifth in a row since Brooklyn ended their 61-game winning streak on Feb. 9. They enter the regional with a 21-1 record.

Hofener scored a team-high 18 points. O'Hara added 15, Thomas 12 and Voiers 11. Chanel's Arthur Jordan led all scorers with 19. Nick Russo scored 15 and Ryan Betori 13 for the Firebirds.

Contact Bob Daniels at (440) 329-7135 or ctsports@chronicle.com.

Lutheran W. 71, Chanel 64

CHANEL (64): Lamar McKnight 2-1-5, Nick Russo 6-1-15, Brendan Coyne 5-0-11, Arthur Jordan 8-2-15, Ryan Betori 4-4-13, Jaquah Brown 0-1-1. Totals 24-48-54.

LUTHERAN WEST (71): Scott Voiers 3-5-11, Jacob O'Hara 4-7-15, Andrew Thomas 4-2-12, Dave Mancini 3-1-7, Paul Fackler 1-0-2, Mike Tetzrow 1-0-2, Andrew Hofener 9-0-18, Jake Szmek 1-0-2. Totals 26-16-71.

Three-point goals: Chanel 7-25 (Russo 4, Coyne, Jordan, Betori); Lutheran West 4-9 (Thomas 2, O'Hara, Voiers). Field goals: Chanel 24-48 (35 percent); Lutheran West 26-50 (43 percent). Free throws: Chanel 9-19; Lutheran West 15-20. Rebounds: Chanel 33; Lutheran West 26. Turnovers: Chanel 16; Lutheran West 20. Fouled out: Jordan.

FALLS

From C1

The Bulldogs (21-2) will play in the Toledo regional, but, oddly, their first regional game will be in Canton at the Fieldhouse on Thursday at 7 p.m. against the Barborton district champion — the winner of tonight's Akron Kenmore-Akron St. Vincent-St. Mary game.

Olmsted Falls can bank on two things at the regional: the impressive play of Sparks, who had 11 of his team's 13 points in the fourth quarter, including a crucial 3-point shot with 2:33 left in the game, and the fact that they've been battle tested.

Holy Name (18-5), never a district champion but four times a runner-up, pushed the top-seeded Bulldogs to the end. Falls couldn't relax until the last nine seconds when Mike Stallard made two free throws and then Sparks came through with a steal and two more from the line with five seconds left.

"We watched them and said, 'We can beat these guys,'" said Sparks. "But then you go out there and realize they're a good team."

"This is the best coached, best prepared team we've played this year," Donahue said of Holy Name. "And that's

not a knock on anybody else, but we knew we'd have a hard-fought battle. It lived up to everyone's expectations."

Two numbers always leap out at teams that play Olmsted Falls: points off turnovers and second-chance points. The Green Wave turned the ball over 22 times, but the Bulldogs never got their usual run-outs from their pressure. And Holy Name stayed even on the glass.

Every time Olmsted Falls seemed ready to take control, Holy Name had an answer.

"Nobody gave us a chance," said Holy Name coach Mark Krakowiak. "But we gave ourselves a chance. Olmsted Falls is the best team we've seen all year, but I'm proud of our effort."

"Every time they made a run, we responded. We never put our heads down."

The most important response came in the last 33 seconds of the first half.

Tom Krakowiak sank a 3-point shot and another opportunity presented itself when Sparks was called for an over-and-back violation — Falls' only turnover of the period — with 5.6 seconds remaining.

"We worked on that (out-of-bounds) play all year," Krakowiak said. "With five seconds left in the half of the district championship game, we finally used it. We got a

three-point play off of it."

In the third quarter the Bulldogs surged in front 40-34 with 1:50 left, but Dan Zust scored off a nice pass from Tom Krakowiak and Danny Day made a basket and free throw to cut it to one.

The Green Wave took a 46-45 lead with 3:41 left in the game, but Sparks hit a baseline jumper and then sank the 3-point shot that made it a four-point game. That was the dagger for Holy Name.

"I think it was Dave Pellerite (who made the pass)," Sparks said. "I was just standing there. It's about time we had a period like that."

"We had the guy we wanted to have it at the end," Donahue said. "He delivered big time."

Contact Roger Negin at (440) 329-7135 or at ctsports@chronicle.com.

Olmsted Falls 56, Holy Name 50

HOLY NAME (50): Tom Krakowiak 4-0-10, Anthony Shanen 5-2-18, Danny Day 4-3-11, Dan Zust 2-0-4, Jim Maslar 0-0-0, John McGoun 0-0-0, Joe DiManno 0-0-0, Mike Yurcak 0-0-0, Tom Benekamp 4-1-9, Mitt Baumbauer 0-0-0. Totals 19-8-50.

OLMSTED FALLS (56): Tyler Sparks 9-7-25, Pat Pellerite 5-5-16, Mike Stallard 1-2-4, Alex Sedlay 0-0-0, Kyle Burdard 0-1-1, Kevin Moenich 0-0-0, Jim Brabec 2-0-6. Totals 19-15-56.

Three-point goals: Holy Name: Krakowiak 2, Shanen 4, Olmsted Falls: Sparks 2, D. Pellerite, Brabec 2. Turnovers: Holy Name 22; Olmsted Falls 12. Rebounds: Holy Name 22 (Day 9); Olmsted Falls 21 (D. Pellerite 7). Fouls: Holy Name 20; Olmsted Falls 14. Fouled out: None. Field goal shooting: Holy Name 19 of 37 (51 percent); Olmsted Falls 18 of 46 (39 percent). Free throw shooting: Holy Name 6 of 9 (67 percent); Olmsted Falls 15 of 19 (79 percent).

Boys basketball

Elyria vs. Strongsville

WHAT: Division I District Championship
WHERE: Midview High School, 38199 Capel Road, Grafton 44044. Bob Maver, Manager. Info: (440) 748-5231.

WHO: Second-seeded Elyria (17-5) vs. top-seeded Strongsville (18-4).

LAST YEAR: Strongsville defeated Elyria, 70-68, for the Midview Division I district title, its first since 2001.

THIS YEAR: Strongsville has defeated Elyria twice — 90-66 at Strongsville in January and 88-80 at Elyria in February.

THE COACHES: Elyria's Hall-of-Fame coach Bob Walsh vs. Strongsville's Joe Lynch.

PROBABLE STARTERS: Elyria will likely start 6-foot-5 senior Danny Noble at the post, 6-1 senior Jordan Thomass along with 6-4 junior Serryl Davis at forwards with 5-9 junior Promis Cabbil at the point with 5-9 shooting guard Demetrius Dalton at the other guard. Strongsville will send 6-5 senior Danny Kelly at post, 6-4 junior Tim Kamczyk and 6-0 Matt Fegan at the wings along with 6-1 senior Nate Korinchak and 5-8 senior Steve Hajdin at guards.

TOP SUBS: Elyria will bring juniors Rayshawn Camel (5-9), Tyler Harrell (6-3) and Travis Noble (6-3) off the bench while Strongsville's first players off the bench will be 5-9 junior JeVon Anderson, 6-4 junior Grant Vanco and 6-0 junior John Grant.

THE LOW DOWN: Elyria is bidding for its first district championship since the days of Richard Montague, Hubert Oliver and Coach Mike Riley way back in 1977. Danny Noble leads the way at 15.8 points per game and 8.8 rebounds. Demetrius Dalton averages 15.1 points. Promis Cabbil is the assists leader with 67 while Jordan Thomas has come up with 77 steals to lead Elyria's defense. Strongsville is led by its one-two punch of Tim Kamczyk (18.7 points) and Danny Kelly (18.2). Kelly averages 11.6 rebounds a game while Kamczyk grabs 7.9 a night. Nate Korinchak plays with a ton of energy and leads the Mustangs in assists (110) and steals (132). For Elyria to win, it must slow down Strongsville to some extent. The Mustangs have been in the 90s on several occasions this season and like to push the action. They are the one team on Elyria's schedule that might be able to cut-run the Pioneers. Elyria will have to take good care of the basketball and grab its share of rebounds to have a chance. It wouldn't hurt if the Pioneers shot their free throws the way they did against Cloverleaf (13 of 14) in their first tournament game. Strongsville feasted at the line in its 88-80 overtime win at Elyria, hitting 40 of 47 free throws. The Pioneers, meanwhile, got to the line just 18 times, sinking 11.

TICKETS: Elyria High will be selling tickets this morning from 11 a.m. to 1 p.m. in the athletic office. Tickets are \$6 for adults, \$4 for students. All tickets at the door will be \$6 if the game is not a sell-out. Elyria will receive 40% of the proceeds for any tickets sold at the school. Mark McGuire's office phone is (440) 284-8256.

BULLETIN BOARD

Schools

BASKETBALL COACH NEEDED: Black River High School is looking for a head boys varsity basketball coach. Teaching positions are unknown at this time. Interested candidates are asked to submit a letter of interest and resume to Pete Keenan, athletic director, Black River High School, 233 County Road 40, Sullivan 44880. Deadline for applications is March 19.

LCCC GOLF OPENINGS: Lorain County Community College's men's golf team has openings for the spring season. Students must be full-time, taking at least 12 credit hours. The fee for joining is \$50. Call 1-800-995-2222, ext. 7346; (440) 366-7346; (440) 458-8236 or e-mail at www.tsabob@lorainccc.edu.

CLEARVIEW BASEBALL CLINIC: Clearview High School is hosting a baseball clinic on March 17, starting at 9 a.m. Ages 6-8 will meet at 9 a.m., ages 9-11 at 11:30 a.m. and ages 12-14 at 2 p.m. Cost is \$25 per participant. Registrations are being accepted in advance or one-half hour before your age group begins. Call (440) 398-6551 or visit www.clearview.k12.oh.us.

SOCCER COACH NEEDED: Southview High School is looking for a head girls soccer coach. Resumes should be sent to athletic director Bryan Koury, 2350 Pole Avenue, Lorain 44052.

TENNIS PRACTICES: Voluntary team practices for Avon's boys junior varsity tennis are being held each Sunday through March. The practices will be held at the North Ridge Racquet Club in North Ridgeville from 4:30-6 p.m. Cost is \$5 for each boy. Mandatory practices start on March 5. Call (440) 933-9071.

OLMSTED FALLS NEEDS SOCCER COACH: Olmsted Falls High School is accepting applications for a head boys soccer coach. Interested applicants should send a cover letter and resume to Rob Coxon, athletic director, Olmsted Falls High School, 26938 Bagley Road, Olmsted Falls 44138 or e-mail at www.rcxon@leeca.org.

TRACK MEET OPENING: Avon Lake High School has an opening for its Boys and Girls Track Invitational on March 31. Interested schools are asked to call athletic director Tom Barone at (440) 933-5164.

SOCCER COACH NEEDED: Keystone High School is accepting applications for boys soccer coach. Send letters of interest to Keystone High School, P.O. Box 65, 580 Opportunity Way, LaGrange, 44050, attention Ted Gordon or Tom Clary. Call (440) 355-5132.

AVON NEEDS COACHES: Avon High School is accepting applications for freshman, junior varsity and assistant varsity baseball coaches. Send a resume and letter of interest to Brent Betts, 35575 Detroit Road, Avon, 44011, or call (440) 937-9660.

BLACK RIVER OPENINGS: Black River High School needs a varsity softball coach. Call athletic director Pete Keenan at (419) 736-3303.

Baseball/Softball

EAST TRYOUTS: Elyria East Little League will have tryouts for boys baseball and girls softball at Elyria High School on March 18. Boys tryouts will be Minor B (ages 8-9) from 2-3 p.m. and Minor A/Majors (ages 10-12) from 3-4:30. Tryouts are mandatory for a child to play in Majors. Junior Boys (ages 13-14) tryouts will be from 4:30-5. Girls tryouts will be Minors (ages 8-10) from 5:45-6:15; Majors (ages 11-12) from 5:45-6:15 and Juniors/Seniors (ages 13-16) from 6:15-6:45. Call (440) 323-0507.

MEET THE ALL-STARS

SENIOR GIRLS ALL-STAR GAMES

Monday, March 19, at Keystone High School
Game 1 at 6 p.m., Game 2 at 8 p.m.
2007 Ms. Basketball announced between games

COLUMBIA

Katie Dula

Basketball Varsity Letters: 3.
2006-07 Statistics: Field-goal percentage — 41.6; Foul-shooting percentage — 66.7; Points per game — 4.4; Rebounds per game — 11.1; Assists per game — 2.1.
Plans: Undecided.

Katie Mahoney

Basketball Varsity Letters: 4.
2006-07 Statistics: Field-goal percentage — 25.9; Foul-shooting percentage — 71.6; Points per game — 8.6; Rebounds per game — 3.8; Assists per game — 1.2.
Plans: Attend Lorain County Community College or the University of Akron and study advertising.

FIRELANDS

Ali Stack

Basketball Varsity Letters: 4.
2006-07 Statistics: Field-goal percentage — 40; Foul-shooting percentage — 64; Points per game — 17; Rebounds per game — 7.1; Assists per game — 5.2; Career points per game — 11.
Plans: Undecided.

Kailey Volk

Basketball Varsity Letters: 2.
2006-07 Statistics: Field-goal percentage — 35; Foul-shooting percentage — 60; Points per game — 5.7; Rebounds per game — 5; Assists per game — 1; Career points per game — 5.
Plans: Undecided.

BRIEFS

Hansen added to all-district

Alex Hansen of Lake Ridge Academy was added to the Division IV girls basketball Northeast Lakes all-district team as an honorable-mention selection Friday.

Hansen, a 5-foot-1 junior guard, was inadvertently left off the original all-district team announced Wednesday by The Associated Press due to a mixup in the selection process. She averaged 14.2 points and 4.3 assists per game.

Clippers claim championship

SHEFFIELD TWP. — Clearview's freshman boys basketball team won the Patriot

Athletic Conference tournament after losing their final regular-season game, the team's only PAC loss.

The season is believed to be the best in school history as the Clippers repeated their performances from when they were eighth-graders.

Falls to host hoops tourney

The Olmsted Falls Youth basketball tournament will be on April 27-29 at Olmsted Falls High School. The tournament is open to boys and girls in grades 4-6.

Entry fee of \$185 includes a minimum of three games and referee fees. Registration deadline is April 6. Call (440) 759-2774.